Same Engagement, Different Outcomes

Explaining differences in academic results among similarly active online learners

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Data Mining Course Project
November 4, 2026

Page-count note. The main text ends on page 9; references, disclosures, and the appendix are excluded from the 6–10 page main-text requirement.

1 Introduction

Online learning platforms record when and how students use course resources. Two students can generate the same number of clicks in the first four weeks and still finish with very different results. Total activity is therefore an entry point, not an explanation: the temporal distribution of study, the mix of resource types, and the way activity changes after the first month may carry information that a single click count hides. This project asks: *among students with similar early engagement, which temporal and resource-use patterns are associated with passing rather than failing?* Withdrawn students are treated as a separate outcome, not as a missing value or as a kind of failure. The project uses the Open University Learning Analytics Dataset (OULAD). The unit of analysis is one enrolment (module × presentation × student), not a unique person; the same student can appear in several presentations. We build an audited pipeline that freezes the analysis configuration, constructs features only from dates before each cutoff, splits by student, and reports calibration and uncertainty rather than a single accuracy figure. The main analyses are (i) coarsened exact matching (CEM) within module and presentation, (ii) clustering of first-month behavioural profiles with bootstrap stability, (iii) a classification ladder M0–M5, and (iv) a cutoff curve with two ways of updating a first-month prediction at week 8. A three-class competing-risk analysis keeps Withdrawn separate, and a specification curve with diagnostics and placebo checks tests whether the conclusions survive reasonable analysis choices. The headline result is qualified. In the main held-out split, the M1 behavioural model reaches PR-AUC 0.827 and ROC-AUC 0.724; grouped cross-validation ROC-AUC is 0.719, forward-temporal ROC-AUC is 0.707, and leave-one-module-out ROC-AUC is 0.699. The spread among the strict models is comparable to the change under temporal/module extrapolation, so neither should be read as a deployment guarantee. The random-label negative control has ROC-AUC 0.530, close to chance. These are associations, not causal effects.

2 Problem Formulation

Let i index an enrolment. The label is $y_i \in \{\text{Pass/Distinction}, \text{Fail}\}$ for the primary target T1; Withdrawn enrolments are excluded from T1 and analysed separately. T2 folds Withdrawn into

the negative class and T3 is the three-class outcome (Pass/Distinction, Fail, Withdrawn). For a cutoff c (days from course start), the feature vector $X_i(c)$ may use only VLE clicks with date $< c$ and assessment submissions with date $< c$. No score, banked-credit flag, final result, or post-cutoff click is allowed in the strict feature set. The predictive task is to estimate $p_i(c) = \Pr(y_i = 1 \mid X_i(c))$ and to rank enrolments by risk. Two windows are defined. W1 is days 0–27. W2 is days 28 to the earlier of day 55 and the first weighted TMA/CMA minus one; when the first TMA is before week 4, the plan falls back to the fixed 28–55 window and records the fallback. OULAD dates are relative to presentation start and include negative values; the primary analysis excludes pre-start clicks, and clipping or a separate pre-start feature is used only in sensitivity analyses. The primary metric is PR-AUC because the positive class is not rare; ROC-AUC is reported for comparability, and recall is reported at a threshold chosen on validation data at precision 0.80. Calibration is assessed with Brier score, calibration slope/intercept, and reliability curves. The cohort is defined in two steps. First, the Withdrawn audit asks whether the click stream stops at `date_unregistration`. It does not: in the full data, 1272 withdrawn students have 29440 click rows after that date. The main cohort therefore keeps all T1 enrolments and treats the at-risk filter as a sensitivity analysis; Withdrawn remains a separate outcome in T3 and the competing-risk model. This is a deliberate correction to the tempting, but unsupported, practice of silently dropping everyone with an early unregistration date.

3 Methodology

3.1 Data and leakage audit

OULAD contains seven tables: courses (22 rows), assessments (206), VLE resources (6,364), studentInfo (32,593 enrolments), studentRegistration (32,593), studentAssessment (173,912), and studentVle (10,655,280). The missing-value marker is `?`, not an empty field. VLE dates range from -25 to 269; 688,988 rows (6.47%) are before course start. The first TMA/CMA is often before day 28, so the W2 end is computed per presentation with the documented fallback. The strict pipeline drops quiz/external-quiz sites, excludes banked assessments from submission features, and never reads `score` outside the M4 upper-bound model. Every feature table records the maximum date actually used and is asserted to be below its cutoff. Features are grouped into volume, composition, breadth, regularity, timing, assessment-submission, and change families. All aggregates are cutoff-aware; no full-period aggregate is computed and then truncated.

3.2 Splits and matching

The primary split is 60/20/20 by `id_student`; a five-fold GroupKFold, a forward-temporal split (2013B/2013J train, 2014B/2014J test), and a leave-one-module-out split are also reported. Temporal and LOMO training rows are further restricted so that no student appears on both sides of a split. In the full-data design, the row-level control quantifies the leakage that a naive random split would create; in this rehearsal all grouped splits have zero student overlap. CEM uses module $\times$ presentation as exact strata and coarsens W1 clicks, active days, and activity entropy within presentation. Strata without both outcomes are discarded; treated units receive weight 1 and controls receive n_t/n_c within stratum. Balance is assessed on the coarsened variables (the design variables) with SMD, and raw continuous SMD is reported as a diagnostic. A cluster bootstrap over strata gives confidence intervals for W2 differences. Matching is descriptive: it balances measured W1 variables and cannot remove unmeasured confounding or post-baseline selection.

Cutoff	Enrolments	T1 n	T1 base	T3 Pass/Dist	T3 Fail	T3 Withdrawn at c
7	32593	22437	68.6%	15385	7052	6749
28	32593	22437	68.6%	15385	7052	5109
56	32593	22437	68.6%	15385	7052	4093

Table 1: Cohort flow at three cutoffs. T1 excludes Withdrawn and is not filtered by date_unregistration in the main analysis, so its counts are constant across cutoffs. T3 reports final full-cohort Pass/Dist and Fail counts separately from Withdrawn observed by cutoff c; the columns are descriptive, not a fixed-size partition. At-risk filtering is a sensitivity analysis, not the main cohort.

3.3 Clustering, models, updating and competing risks

Clustering uses W1 volume, breadth, regularity, and composition features, standardised within presentation and reduced by PCA to eight components. k-means is run for $k = 2, \ldots, 8$ with 50 initialisations. Stability is measured by 300 bootstrap refits: ARI against the full-sample partition and cluster-wise Jaccard after Hungarian label alignment. The project threshold is mean ARI ≥ 0.60; this is a project convention, not a literature constant. The model ladder adds one feature family at a time: M0 uses log clicks and active days; M1 adds breadth, regularity, and composition; M2 adds timing; M3 adds assessment submission timing without scores; M4 adds scores as an upper bound; M5 replaces the logistic model with HistGradientBoosting on M3 features. A context-only baseline (M-1) uses demographic and registration variables; M0c and M1c add the M0 and M1 features to that baseline, separating the clickstream increment from context. All preprocessing is fitted inside the training fold. The classification threshold is selected on validation data at precision 0.80 (falling back to maximum F1 when that precision is unreachable), then applied once to the held-out test set. Bootstrap intervals resample held-out rows. For updating, the cutoff curve retrains M0–M3 at each cutoff on the same split. B1 stacking adds a cross-fitted W1 probability to a W2 model; B2 uses $\text{logit}(p_{W1})$ as a fixed offset in a binomial GLM. Cross-fitting is done with an inner GroupKFold on the training rows, so a row's W1 probability never comes from the same fit that predicts it. The competing-risk analysis fits a three-class multinomial model and cause-specific Cox models on weekly event times; the cumulative incidence function is computed with the Aalen–Johansen recursion. The specification curve varies cutoff, pre-start handling, minimum W1 clicks, target, feature level, model family, matching method, and clustering k, and adds random-label, pre-start-only, and placebo-window diagnostics.

4 Experiments

4.1 Data, cohort and overlap

The analysis dataset has 32593 enrolments; T1 contains 22437 with base rate 68.6%, and 10156 enrolments are Withdrawn. Table 1 shows the cohort at three cutoffs. The W1 click distributions of Pass/Distinction and Fail overlap substantially but not completely: the presentation-weighted histogram-intersection coefficient ranges from 0.683 to 0.737 across cutoffs, and the zero-click share at day 28 is 4.2%. This supports the premise that similar early engagement exists, but the overlap is not complete. CEM common support for T1 is 0.900, so the matched comparison covers most of the treated group.

Split	Train n	Test n	Train pos.	Test pos.	Student overlap
Grouped 60/20/20	13437	4492	68.6%	67.7%	0
2013→2014	9158	12625	66.2%	69.8%	0
LOMO (7 folds)	18877.9	3205.3	–	–	0

Table 2: Held-out designs. Student overlap is zero by construction.

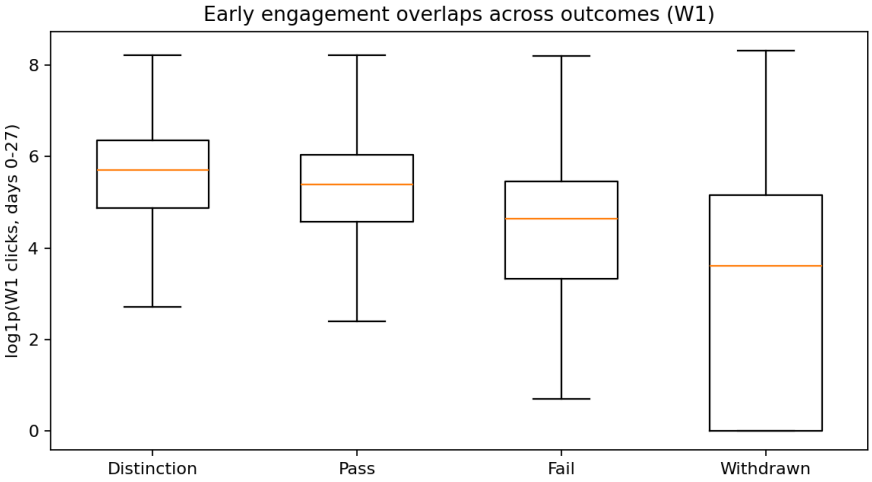


Figure 1: W1 click distributions by final outcome. Overlap is substantial but incomplete; it determines the common support available to matching.

4.2 Matching and behavioural profiles

CEM retained 20660 T1 enrolments in strata containing both outcomes. Balance on the coarsened design variables is exact by construction (maximum |SMD| 0.000); the raw continuous diagnostic has maximum |SMD| 0.033. Common support for treated units is 0.900, so the matched comparison describes the overlap region rather than a population-average effect. Within matched strata, the Pass/Distinction minus Fail differences (95% cluster-bootstrap CI) are 37.558 [30.343, 44.274] for click change, 1.721 [1.511, 1.903] for active-day change, and 0.032 [0.023, 0.041] for activity-entropy change. Figure 2 summarises balance; Table 3 reports the model ladder. The E-value for the high-vs-low W2-change contrast is 1.555; an unmeasured confounder with risk ratio about 1.555 could explain that contrast. This is a modest E-value, so the matched contrast is fragile to unmeasured confounding. Matching-method contrasts on the same W2 click change are 37.558 (CEM), 7.774 (PSM), and 33.239 (stratified); the magnitude differs across methods; this is a descriptive sensitivity rather than a directional effect. The exposure-definition sensitivity is summarised in Appendix Table 15. Clustering selected k=2 with mean bootstrap ARI 0.913 and minimum cluster Jaccard 0.810. k=2 is the most stable partition; it was selected by the stability-first rule, although k=3 has a higher silhouette (0.235 vs 0.248). The 2 profiles differ in outcome mix, and no profile is homogeneous. The cluster labels are behavioural descriptions, not learning-style types, and the chosen partition should not be read as a latent class model.

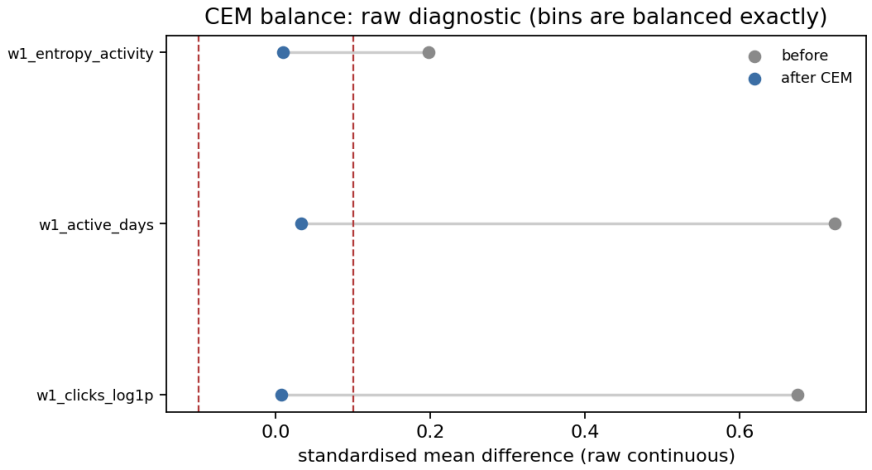


Figure 2: CEM balance. The bins used to define strata are balanced; raw continuous active days retain a residual difference, which is reported rather than hidden.

Metric	M0	M1	M2	M3	M4	M5
PR-AUC	0.816	0.827	0.827	0.828	0.843	0.838
ROC-AUC	0.701	0.724	0.724	0.729	0.744	0.738
Recall at val threshold	0.648	0.730	0.728	0.748	0.785	0.773
Precision at val threshold	0.795	0.783	0.787	0.788	0.784	0.785
F1	0.714	0.755	0.756	0.768	0.785	0.779
Brier	0.220	0.213	0.213	0.211	0.207	0.204
Calibration slope	1.029	0.987	0.976	0.991	0.931	0.983

Table 3: Main held-out test (grouped split). M4 contains scores and is an upper bound only.

4.3 Classification ladder and external validation

Table 3 reports the main held-out test. The highest main-test PR-AUC is M4 (0.843); the ladder is monotone across M0–M3. M4 is an upper bound because scores are not known at prediction time; it is not an early-warning model. Among strict models, M5 has the highest main-test PR-AUC (0.838), but its temporal and LOMO ROC-AUC (0.702, 0.681) are lower than M1's (0.707, 0.699); the ranking is not stable across extrapolation. The calibration slope of M4 is 0.931; slopes below 1 indicate over-confident probabilities, which is why Brier and reliability curves are reported alongside ranking metrics. Table 5 adds a context-only baseline. Context alone reaches PR-AUC 0.783 and ROC-AUC 0.657. Adding click volume (M0c) gives 0.853, and adding behaviour (M1c) gives 0.854. The paired M1c–M0c difference is 0.001 PR-AUC (95% CI [-0.004, 0.006]) and 0.005 ROC-AUC (95% CI [0.001, 0.010]) on the same test rows. The PR-AUC CI includes zero, so the behavioural increment is not detectable on PR-AUC; the ROC-AUC CI excludes zero, but the difference is small. The point estimate is small in absolute terms; the CI is the basis for the detectability statement. The contrast is descriptive: context variables are not randomised, and the context-only model is imperfect, so we do not claim a context-adjusted effect. Module-level PR-AUC ranges from 0.778 to 0.964; subgroup calibration slopes range from 0.571 to 1.933, and subgroup recall ranges from 0.653 to 0.929. The lowest module PR-AUC is GGG (0.778); the lowest subgroup recall is highest_education:Post Graduate Qualification (0.653). Groups with fewer than

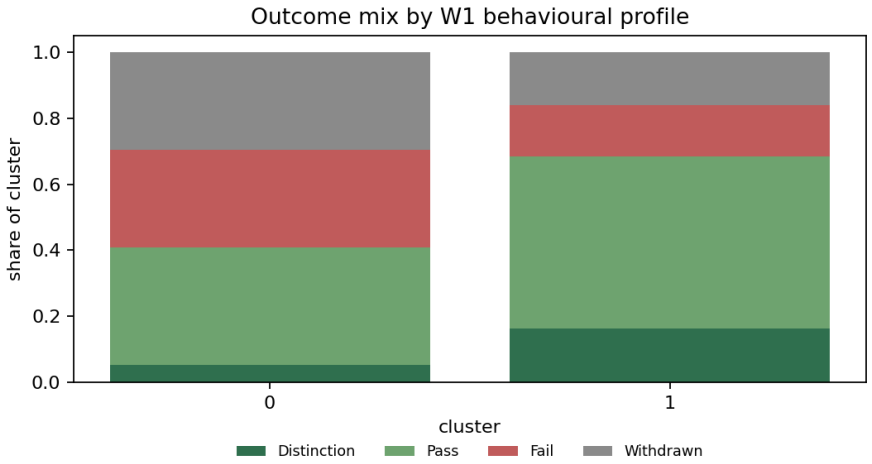


Figure 3: Outcome mix by W1 behavioural profile. Clusters are descriptive; the within-cluster outcome variation is the phenomenon of interest.

Model	CV PR	CV ROC	2013→2014 PR	2013→2014 ROC	LOMO PR	LOMO ROC
M0	0.821	0.698	0.832	0.704	0.814	0.684
M1	0.833	0.719	0.831	0.707	0.817	0.699
M3	0.835	0.725	0.823	0.702	0.808	0.690
M5	0.844	0.740	0.828	0.702	0.812	0.681

Table 4: Grouped CV, forward-temporal and leave-one-module-out performance.

200 test rows are flagged low-n; groups with fewer than five rows, a single outcome class, or a missing value are omitted, so counts need not sum to the test n. These are performance differences, not evidence that the model causes them; per-group tables and figures are in Appendix B.

4.4 Cutoff curve and updating

Table 6 and Figure 7 show M3 as the observation window grows. The best PR-AUC is at day 56; day 56 changes it by 0.033 relative to day 28. The curve is monotone in this run, so the cutoff choice is not innocuous. Matched weekly trajectories (Table 14, Figure 8) show a first stable divergence at week 3. Because week 3 lies inside W1 (days 0–27), the matched groups were already diverging during the baseline window; the same-engagement premise is approximate, not exact. Table 7 compares W1-only, W2-only, all-features, and stacking (B1) at day 56. 3 of 3 valid updating methods have a 95% interval for the increment above zero; the largest PR-AUC is B1_stacking (0.863, Δ 0.035). B2 is excluded from the table and reported in Appendix Table 16 as a failed specification; it is not evidence about sequential updating. Even where the interval excludes zero, the increment is small relative to the between-specification spread, so we treat it as provisional.

4.5 Competing risks

The three-class model keeps Withdrawn separate (Table 8). The lowest F1 among the three classes is Fail (0.371); the precision/recall trade-off differs by class. Landmark cause-specific Cox models at

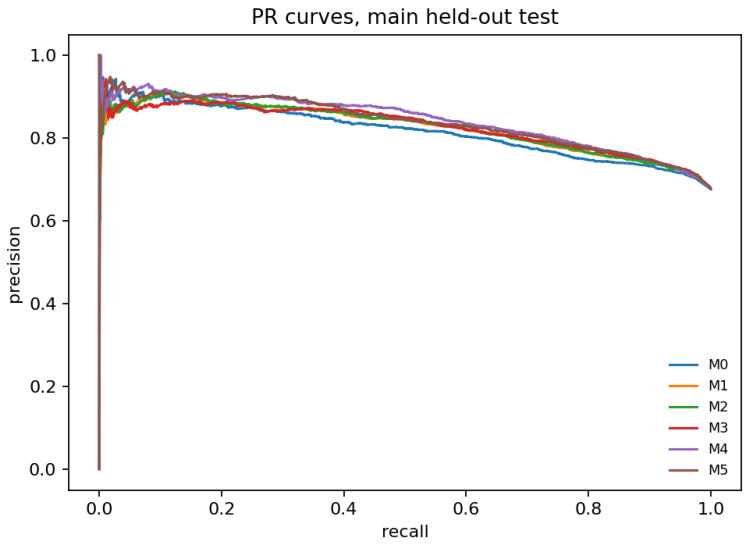


Figure 4: Precision–recall curves on the main held-out test for M0–M5.

Model	PR-AUC	ROC-AUC	Recall	Brier	Cal. slope
M-1_context	0.783	0.657	0.368	0.230	0.906
M0c_context+M0	0.853	0.761	0.805	0.199	1.000
M1c_context+M1	0.854	0.766	0.821	0.196	0.957

Table 5: Context-only and context-adjusted models on the same held-out split. Context variables are never part of the strict clickstream set. M1c–M0c paired differences (95% CI; PR interval includes zero): ΔPR-AUC 0.001 [-0.004, 0.006]; ΔROC-AUC 0.005 [0.001, 0.010] (4492 test rows, 1,000 paired bootstraps).

days 28 and 56 use only features available at the landmark and are evaluated by test concordance (Appendix Table 11); we do not interpret the landmark coefficients causally. The cumulative-incidence curves in Figure 9 make the competition explicit: by the end of the course most enrolments have either passed or withdrawn, and a binary 'Fail' label would hide that distinction.

4.6 Diagnostics and placebo checks

37 predictive specifications; PR-AUC median 0.823, range 0.651–0.862; share above the baseline 40.5%. The random-label leak check is close to chance, which argues against a gross leakage bug. The pre-start-only positive control is 0.782 (above the no-skill PR-AUC and therefore not a null); the future-window control is 0.861 (post-outcome persistence; a placebo failure, not a leak test). The repeater negative-control outcome reaches ROC-AUC 0.657. These diagnostics bound interpretation; they do not identify a clean null or prove the absence of leakage. Table 9 lists each diagnostic with its role and interpretation. The non-assessment-exposure diagnostic reaches ROC-AUC 0.593 (PR-AUC 0.752); if predictive, it indicates generic engagement or background rather than a learning-strategy signal. Measurement sensitivity: quiz inclusion changes M1/M3 PR-AUC by -0.001/-0.000. The exposure-definition CEM gives W2 click differences from -27.621 to 37.558; the seven CEM bin grids range from 34.451 to 39.814. These measurement and matching comparisons are diagnostics, not causal evidence.

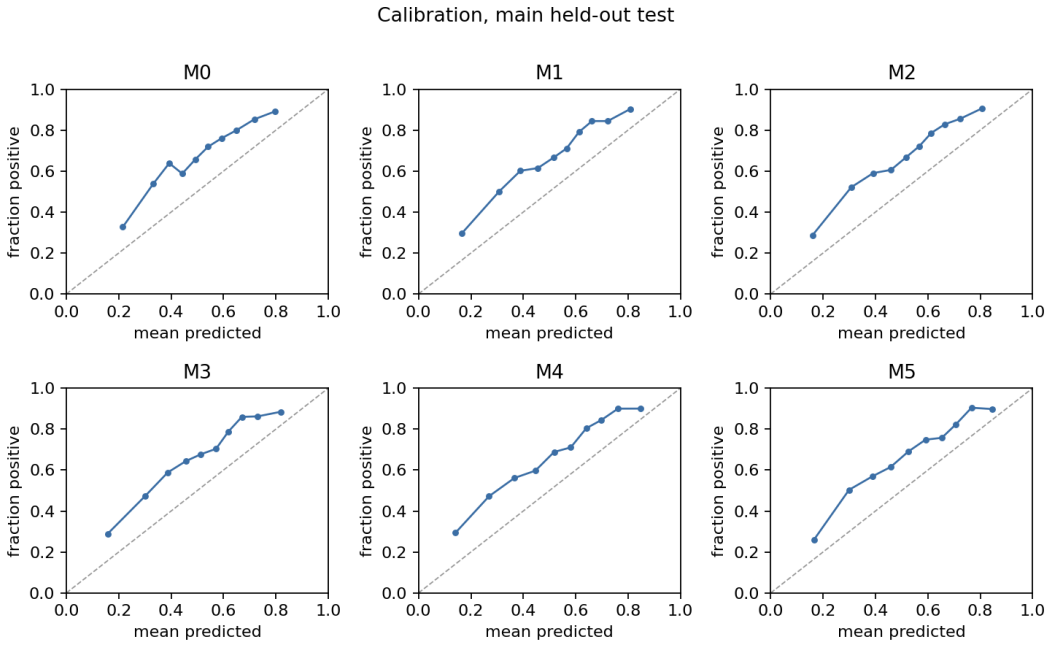


Figure 5: Reliability curves on the main held-out test. Several richer models are over-confident; M4 is an upper bound with scores.

Cutoff	PR-AUC	ROC-AUC	Recall	Precision	Brier
7	0.799	0.671	0.549	0.797	0.230
14	0.815	0.702	0.675	0.787	0.221
21	0.823	0.724	0.727	0.792	0.213
28	0.828	0.729	0.748	0.788	0.211
35	0.836	0.742	0.758	0.798	0.206
42	0.836	0.743	0.770	0.797	0.205
49	0.838	0.746	0.764	0.798	0.203
56	0.862	0.779	0.856	0.791	0.189

Table 6: M3 performance as the observation window grows (fixed cohort).

5 Conclusion and Limitations

The pipeline answers the research question with a qualified yes: early behavioural structure adds information beyond total clicks in the main split, but the context-adjusted M1c-minus-M0c difference is 0.001 PR-AUC (95% CI [-0.004, 0.006]) with no detectable behavioural increment beyond context on PR-AUC; the ROC-AUC difference is small, and the overall increment is small, unstable across extrapolation settings, and sensitive to the operationalisation of engagement. The most defensible conclusions are negative and methodological. First, row-level splitting is not acceptable; grouping by student changes the evaluation and removes a design-level leak; this rehearsal has zero student overlap, so it does not estimate the size of that leak. Second, Withdrawn cannot be treated as a missing label: the click stream does not stop at unregistration, and the three outcomes have different mechanisms. Third, a richer model is not automatically better; calibration and external validation matter more than a small PR-AUC gain on a random split. Limitations are substantial. The data are observational; matching balances only measured W1 variables, and W1 engagement

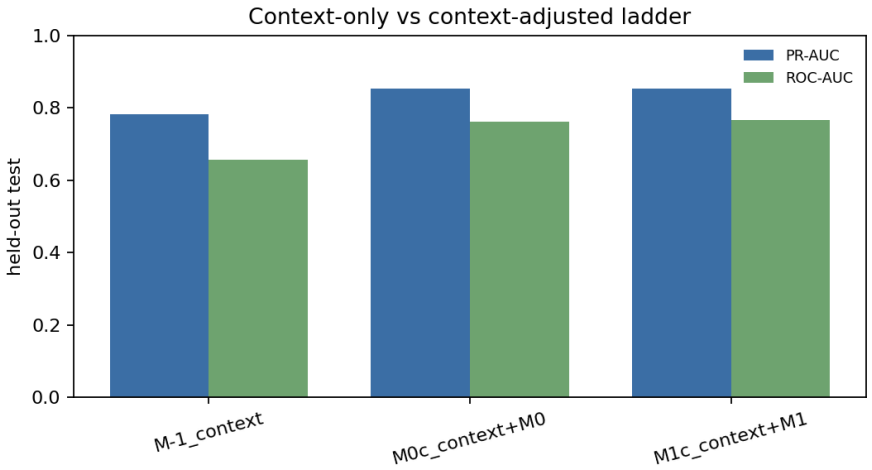


Figure 6: Context-only, context-plus-volume, and context-plus-behaviour models on the same held-out split.

Method	PR-AUC	Δ vs W1	95% CI	Brier	Cal. slope	Status
W1_only_M3	0.828	0.000	[0.000, 0.000]	0.211	0.990	ok
W2_only	0.861	0.032	[0.020, 0.044]	0.193	0.992	ok
All_features_c56	0.862	0.034	[0.025, 0.042]	0.189	1.013	ok
B1_stacking	0.863	0.035	[0.023, 0.046]	0.191	1.008	ok

Table 7: W1→W2 updating at day 56. The main table contains the four valid methods; B2 offset is excluded as a failed specification and is reported in Appendix Table 16. A CI spanning zero means no demonstrated increment.

is already post-baseline, so the matched differences are associations, not causal effects. Clicks are a weak proxy for study time; OULAD has no session timestamps and no reliable time-on-task measure. The full cohort is larger, but the held-out test set and the temporal fold still limit precision. CEM diagnostics are acceptable on the coarsened design (raw max |SMD| 0.033, treated support 0.900), but matching is still descriptive. The optional TMA appendix analyses were not attempted: the +21/+28 window overlaps W1/W2 and conditions on continued enrolment, the +14 anchor varies by presentation, and first-TMA scores are not available at the early cutoff. They are alternative, post-hoc estimands, not early-warning evidence. Finally, the project does not attempt a formal Bayesian prior-to-posterior model; the updating analysis is a predictive engineering comparison, not a posterior inference. Table 10 lists the main threats and residual risks. 93 Withdrawn enrolments have no date_unregistration and are treated as course-end events; the T3 held-out test has n=6508, not the T1 test n. The day-28 zero-click share is 4.2% in T1 but 14.4% in the full queue. Main-text page count excludes references, disclosures, and the appendix.

Disclosures

External collaborators: none. Data: OULAD is a public dataset; no restricted or personal data were used beyond the public release. AIGC: Claude Code (Anthropic) was used to scaffold the analysis code, execute the staged pipeline, generate tables and figures, and draft this report. The pipeline's outputs are generated by the committed code and logged with configuration hashes; the

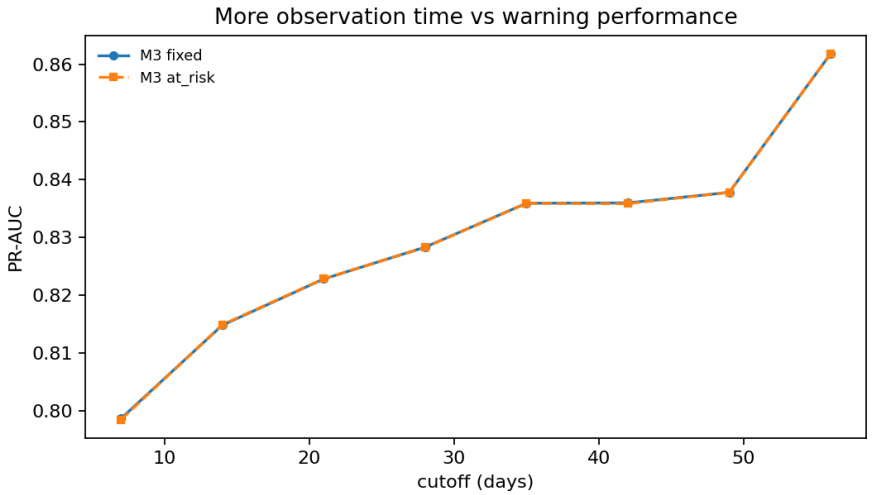


Figure 7: M3 PR-AUC versus cutoff for the fixed and at-risk cohorts. The at-risk filter is a sensitivity analysis, not the main cohort.

Class	Precision	Recall	F1	Support	Macro F1
Fail	0.323	0.435	0.371	1449	0.542
Pass	0.684	0.676	0.680	3106	0.542
Withdrawn	0.663	0.507	0.575	1953	0.542

Table 8: Three-class outcome at day 28 on the held-out test (Pass/Distinction, Fail, Withdrawn).

group is responsible for reviewing the final submission. No references were fabricated; every cited source is listed below.

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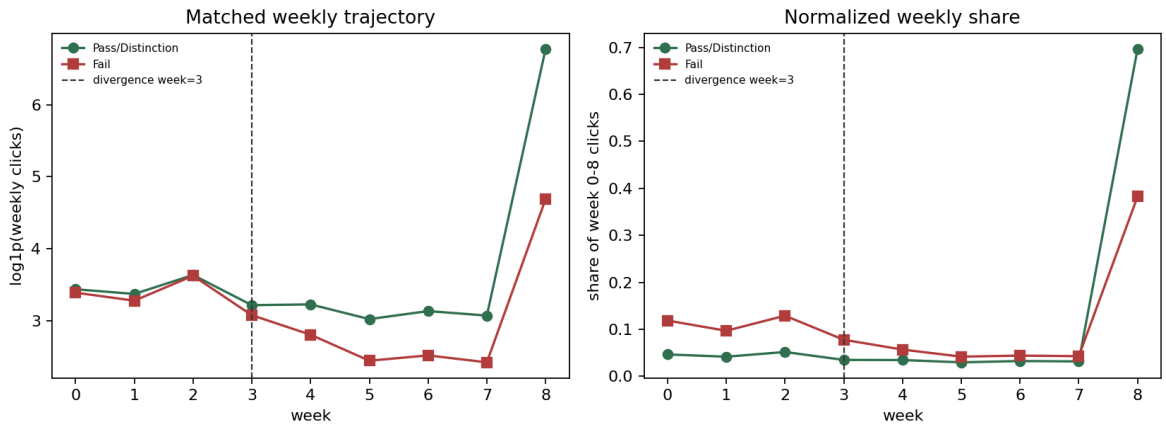


Figure 8: Matched weekly trajectories, absolute log-clicks and normalized share. The divergence week is descriptive, not causal.

Diagnostic	Metric	Value	Role	Interpretation
random_labels	roc_auc	0.530	leak_check	leakage sanity check; expected ~0.5
pre_start_only	pr_auc	0.782	positive_control	positive control for early signal; not a null
placebo_window_56_83	pr_auc	0.861	placebo_failure	post-outcome persistence; placebo failure, not a leak test
num_of_prev_attempts_gt0	roc_auc	0.657	negative_control_outcome	negative-control outcome; behaviour may encode background
non_assessment_w2_change	pr_auc	0.752	negative_control_exposure	non-assessment W2 change; if predictive, generic engagement/confounding
non_assessment_w2_change	roc_auc	0.593	negative_control_exposure	non-assessment W2 change; if predictive, generic engagement/confounding

Table 9: Diagnostics and placebo checks. Roles distinguish leak checks, positive controls, placebo failures, negative-control outcomes, and negative-control exposures; non-null values are not clean nulls.

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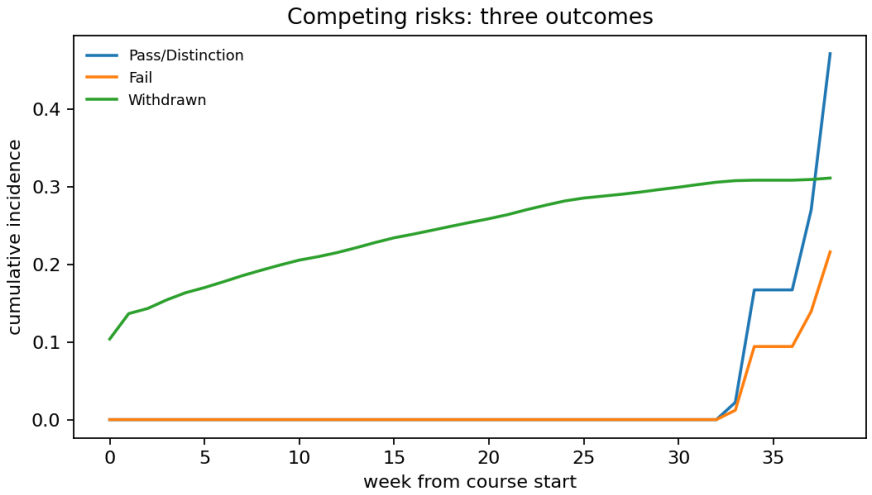


Figure 9: Cumulative incidence of Pass/Distinction, Fail, and Withdrawn. Withdrawn is a competing event, not a missing label.

Threat	Mitigation	Residual risk
Leakage (future clicks/scores)	Cutoff assertions, grouped splits, M4 upper bound	Feature availability after marking remains unobserved for M4
Confounding	CEM on W1 variables, E-value, diagnostic checks	W1 engagement is post-baseline; unmeasured confounding remains
Measurement	Multiple engagement operationalisations and quiz sensitivity	Clicks are a weak proxy for study time
External validity	2013→2014 and LOMO splits	Performance drops outside random CV
Fairness	Module/subgroup metrics and calibration	Small subgroups; no causal claim
Withdrawal	Three-class model and cumulative incidence	93 Withdrawn enrolments lack date_unregistration
T3 test size	T3 split reported separately	T3 test n=6508, not the T1 test n

Table 10: Limitations and residual risks.

A Landmark Cox

The landmark-28 model uses only W1 features; the landmark-56 model uses W1 and W2 features available at day 56. Both exclude events at or before the landmark and report held-out test concordance, addressing the static-W2 leakage in the baseline appendix. The table reports concordance; coefficient-level HR and 95% CI are in `t10_landmark_cox.csv`.

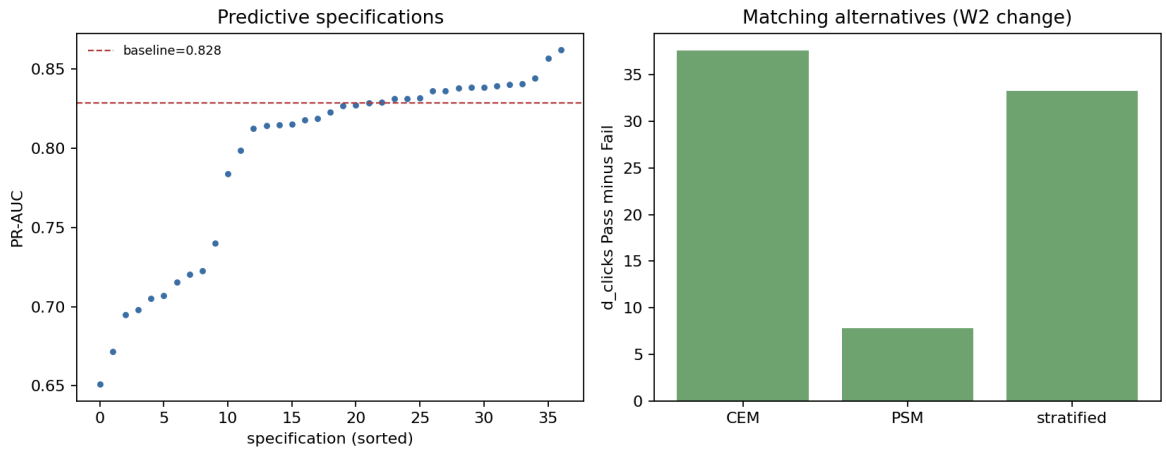


Figure 10: Specification curve: predictive specifications (left) and matching-method effects on W2 click change (right).

Landmark	Cause	Train n	Test n	Events train	Events test	Test C
28	Fail	16544	5541	4228	1449	0.662
28	Pass	16544	5541	9202	3106	0.560
28	Withdrawn	16544	5541	3114	986	0.572
56	Fail	15927	5336	4228	1449	0.660
56	Pass	15927	5336	9202	3106	0.582
56	Withdrawn	15927	5336	2497	781	0.557

Table 11: Landmark cause-specific Cox. Features are available at the landmark; concordance is computed on the held-out test split.

B Module and subgroup metrics

C Trajectory and clustering diagnostics

D Sensitivity tables

E B2 offset (failed specification)

B2 was attempted with a fixed logit(pW1) offset, both without and with an intercept. The selected fit remains severely over-confident; it is retained here only for transparency and is not a sequential-updating result.

Module	n	PR-AUC	ROC-AUC	Recall	Brier	Cal. slope	low n
AAA	114	0.964	0.825	0.906	0.158	1.850	yes
BBB	1166	0.808	0.732	0.749	0.210	1.082	no
CCC	512	0.820	0.698	0.687	0.229	1.175	no
DDD	785	0.823	0.722	0.831	0.200	1.131	no
EEE	457	0.900	0.790	0.853	0.186	1.693	no
FFF	1037	0.835	0.772	0.805	0.189	0.998	no
GGG	421	0.778	0.644	0.361	0.307	0.709	no

Table 12: Per-module held-out metrics for M3. Groups with fewer than five test rows or a single outcome class are omitted, so counts need not sum to the test n; low n = fewer than 200 test rows.

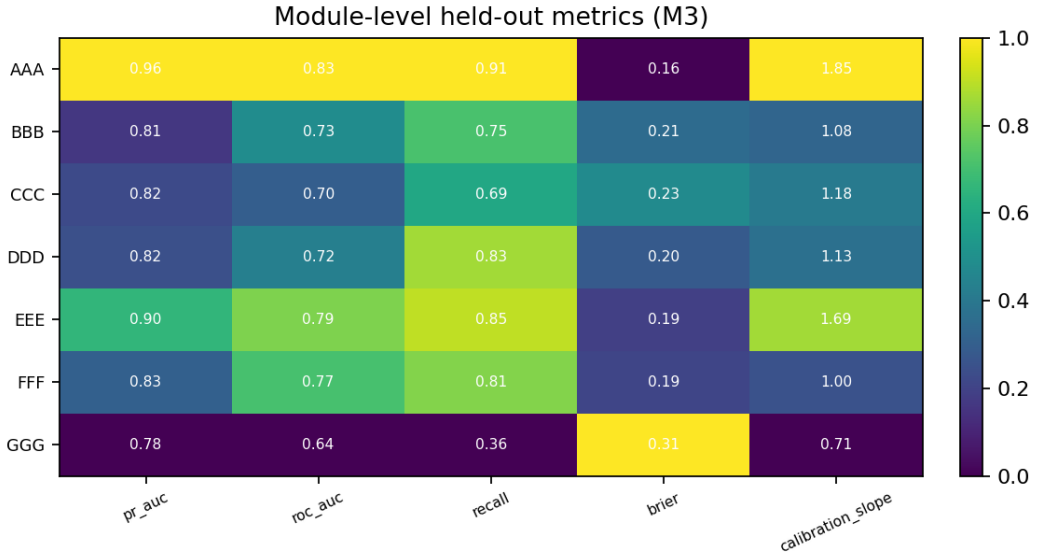


Figure 11: Per-module held-out metrics (M3). Column-normalized for display; cell labels are raw values.

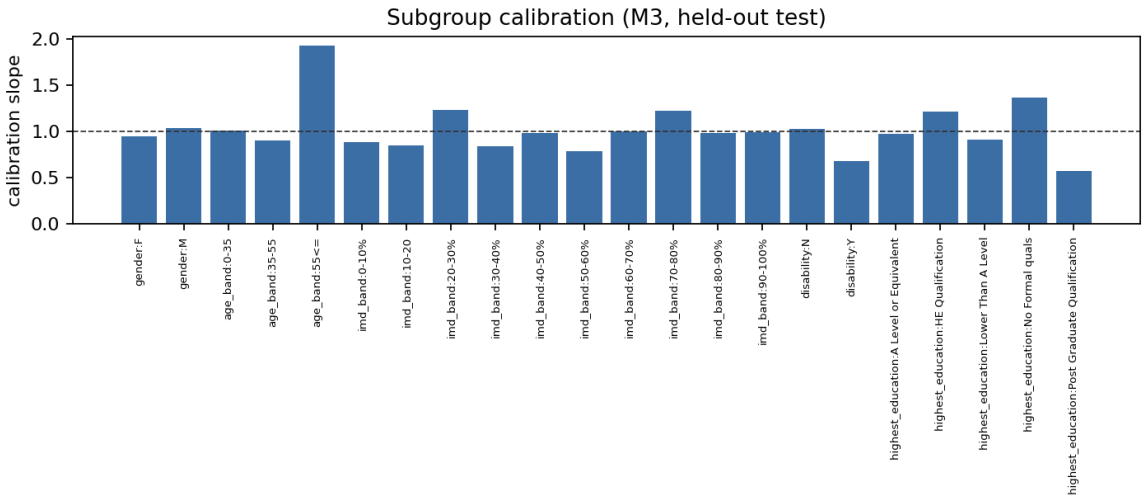


Figure 12: Subgroup calibration slopes (M3, held-out test).

Group type	Group	n	PR-AUC	ROC-AUC	Recall	Cal. slope	low n
gender	F	2058	0.817	0.719	0.719	0.947	no
gender	M	2434	0.838	0.740	0.773	1.041	no
age_band	0-35	3085	0.815	0.728	0.736	1.013	no
age_band	35-55	1373	0.849	0.717	0.769	0.902	no
age_band	55<=	34	0.910	0.827	0.929	1.933	yes
imd_band	0-10%	419	0.687	0.724	0.706	0.889	no
imd_band	10-20	471	0.749	0.705	0.697	0.852	no
imd_band	20-30%	439	0.842	0.772	0.789	1.234	no
imd_band	30-40%	472	0.834	0.712	0.708	0.844	no
imd_band	40-50%	463	0.841	0.724	0.734	0.982	no
imd_band	50-60%	448	0.808	0.680	0.731	0.789	no
imd_band	60-70%	429	0.873	0.740	0.775	1.002	no
imd_band	70-80%	449	0.881	0.764	0.756	1.227	no
imd_band	80-90%	381	0.870	0.712	0.736	0.987	no
imd_band	90-100%	350	0.857	0.714	0.803	0.988	no
disability	N	4097	0.838	0.735	0.752	1.032	no
disability	Y	395	0.733	0.680	0.708	0.676	no
highest_education	A Level or Equivalent	1976	0.856	0.722	0.738	0.973	no
highest_education	HE Qualification	728	0.883	0.759	0.813	1.219	no
highest_education	Lower Than A Level	1702	0.766	0.724	0.732	0.914	no
highest_education	No Formal quals	31	0.717	0.739	0.765	1.370	yes
highest_education	Post Graduate Qualification	55	0.927	0.663	0.653	0.571	yes

Table 13: Subgroup held-out metrics for M3. Groups with fewer than five test rows, a single outcome class, or a missing value are omitted, so counts need not sum to the test n; low n = fewer than 200 test rows.

Week	n Pass	n Fail	Pass mean	Fail mean	Diff	95% CI
0	13844	6816	3.435	3.388	0.047	[-0.005, 0.094]
1	13844	6816	3.370	3.277	0.093	[0.048, 0.140]
2	13844	6816	3.633	3.622	0.011	[-0.027, 0.051]
3	13844	6816	3.214	3.075	0.139	[0.093, 0.183]
4	13844	6816	3.225	2.804	0.421	[0.365, 0.474]
5	13844	6816	3.020	2.443	0.578	[0.520, 0.637]
6	13844	6816	3.132	2.516	0.615	[0.555, 0.679]
7	13844	6816	3.070	2.420	0.650	[0.586, 0.715]
8	13844	6816	6.773	4.688	2.085	[1.994, 2.173]

Table 14: Matched weekly trajectory (log1p clicks), cluster-bootstrap CI.

Family	Comparison	Value	95% CI	n
quiz	M1 strict vs included	-0.001	–	–
quiz	M3 strict vs included	-0.000	–	–
exposure	total_clicks_only	36.161	[28.082, 44.467]	22345
exposure	active_days_only	25.168	[14.958, 34.906]	22341
exposure	activity_entropy_only	-27.621	[-43.862, -14.527]	22437
exposure	all_three	37.558	[30.629, 43.494]	20660
matching bins	range over 7 bin grids	34.451 to 39.814	–	–
repeater diagnostic	repeater prediction ROC	0.657	–	–

Table 15: Measurement and matching sensitivity checks. Values are differences or diagnostic metrics, not causal effects.

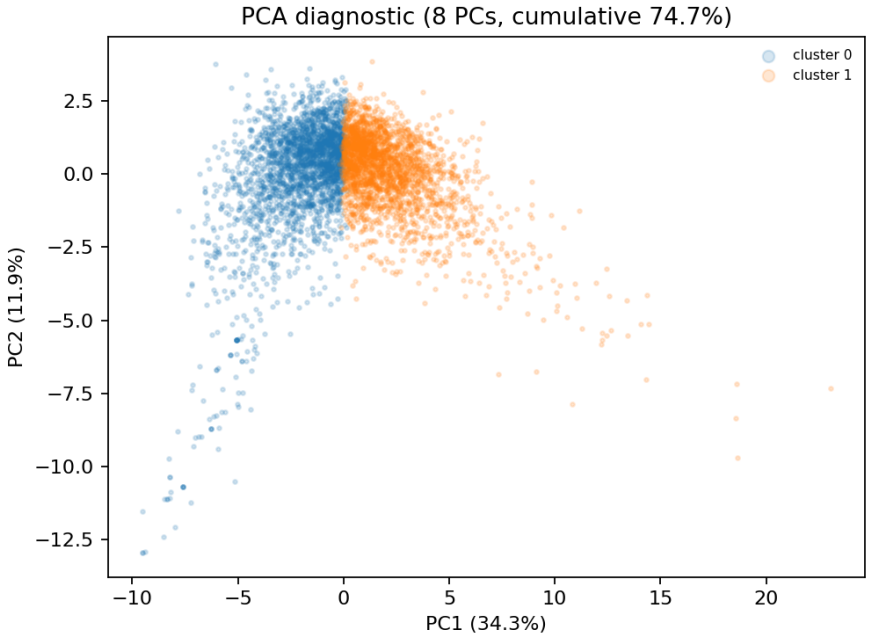


Figure 13: PCA diagnostic: PC1 x PC2, coloured by the chosen k-means partition. The 8-component solution explains the variance shown; this is a diagnostic, not evidence that clusters are real.

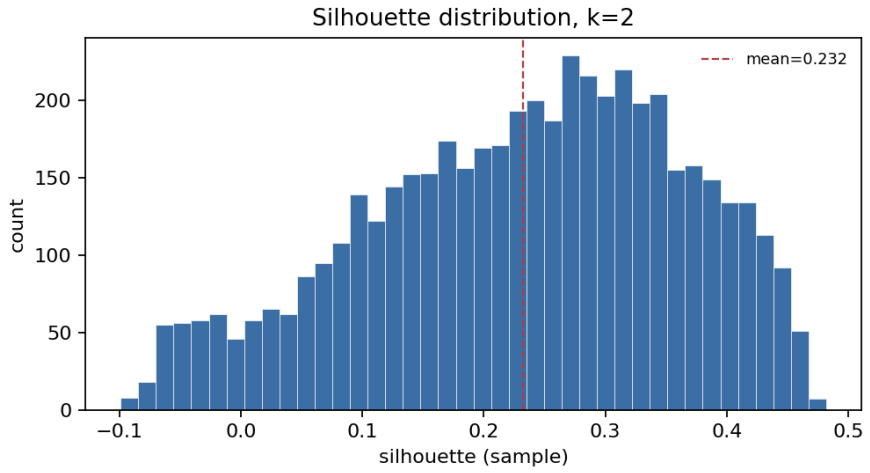


Figure 14: Silhouette distribution for the chosen k (sampled).

Method	PR-AUC	Δ vs W1	95% CI	Brier	Cal. slope	Status
B2_offset	0.759	-0.069	[-0.083, -0.054]	0.304	0.051	failed_calibration

Table 16: B2 offset at day 56. B2 is a failed calibration specification (calibration slope 0.051, Brier 0.304); it is not evidence about sequential updating.